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Method, apparatus, and system for providing mock map data for map design validation and documentation

Abstract

An approach is provided for mock map data for map design validation. For example, the approach involves calculating one or more combinations of one or more map feature attributes, one or more map feature attribute values, or a combination thereof. The approach also involves creating one or more geometric features respectively for the one or more combinations. The approach further involves determining an arrangement of the one or more geometric features within a designated geographic area. The approach further involves generating mock map data based on the arrangement and providing the mock map data to a map client. The map client, for instance, renders the mock map data in a map image based on a map style taxonomy.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

(1) Mapping, navigation, and other similar location-based applications and services use map rendering to transform digital map data into a map image for display on a client device. As part of this process, cartography design teams assign appearance styles to map features based on the feature type/attribute (e.g., types of roads, points of interest, cities, etc.) and feature attribute values (e.g., size/class of roads, points of interest, cities, etc.). However, the possible combinations of different appearances of the features quickly increase as the number of map features and appearance options increase. As a result, mapping service providers face significant technical challenges to observing and validating changes to map styles to ensure readability, design aesthetics, etc. across the possible combinations of map features (e.g., 1,000 or more different possible combinations).

SOME EXAMPLE EMBODIMENTS

(2) Therefore, there is a need for providing mock map data that include procedurally generated map feature attributes and attribute within a relatively small area (e.g., within an area of a traditional map tile or combination of map tiles) for map design validation and/or documentation.

(3) According to one embodiment, a method comprises calculating one or more combinations of one or more map feature attributes, one or more map feature attribute values, or a combination thereof. The method also comprises creating one or more geometric features respectively for the one or more combinations. The method further comprises determining an arrangement of the one or more geometric features within a designated geographic area (e.g., area of a map tile). The method further comprises generating mock map data based on the arrangement. The method further comprises providing the mock map data to a map client. In one embodiment, the map client renders the mock map data in a map image based on a map style taxonomy.

(4) According to another embodiment, an apparatus comprises at least one processor, and at least one memory including computer program code for one or more computer programs, the at least one memory and the computer program code configured to, with the at least one processor, cause, at least in part, the apparatus to calculate one or more combinations of one or more map feature attributes, one or more map feature attribute values, or a combination thereof. The apparatus is also caused to create one or more geometric features respectively for the one or more combinations. The apparatus is further caused to determine an arrangement of the one or more geometric features within a designated geographic area (e.g., area of a map tile). The apparatus is further caused to generate mock map data based on the arrangement. The apparatus is further caused to provide the mock map data to a map client. In one embodiment, the map client renders the mock map data in a map image based on a map style taxonomy.

(5) According to another embodiment, a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium carries one or more sequences of one or more instructions which, when executed by one or more processors, cause, at least in part, an apparatus to calculate one or more combinations of one or more map feature attributes, one or more map feature attribute values, or a combination thereof. The apparatus is also caused to create one or more geometric features respectively for the one or more combinations. The apparatus is further caused to determine an arrangement of the one or

more geometric features within a designated geographic area (e.g., area of a map tile). The apparatus is further caused to generate mock map data based on the arrangement. The apparatus is further caused to provide the mock map data to a map client. In one embodiment, the map client renders the mock map data in a map image based on a map style taxonomy.

(6) Also, according to another embodiment, a computer program product may be provided. For example, a computer program product comprising instructions which, when the program is executed by a computer, cause the computer to carry out the steps described herein.

(7) According to another embodiment, an apparatus comprises means for calculating one or more combinations of one or more map feature attributes, one or more map feature attribute values, or a combination thereof. The apparatus also comprises means for creating one or more geometric features respectively for the one or more combinations. The apparatus further comprises means for determining an arrangement of the one or more geometric features within a designated geographic area (e.g., area of a map tile). The apparatus further comprises means for generating mock map data based on the arrangement. The apparatus further comprises means for providing the mock map data to a map client. In one embodiment, the map client renders the mock map data in a map image based on a map style taxonomy.

(8) In addition, for various example embodiments of the invention, the following is applicable: a method comprising facilitating a processing of and/or processing (1) data and/or (2) information and/or (3) at least one signal, the (1) data and/or (2) information and/or (3) at least one signal based, at least in part, on (or derived at least in part from) any one or any combination of methods (or processes) disclosed in this application as relevant to any embodiment of the invention.

(9) For various example embodiments of the invention, the following is also applicable: a method comprising facilitating access to at least one interface configured to allow access to at least one service, the at least one service configured to perform any one or any combination of network or service provider methods (or processes) disclosed in this application.

(10) For various example embodiments of the invention, the following is also applicable: a method comprising facilitating creating and/or facilitating modifying (1) at least one device user interface element and/or (2) at least one device user interface functionality, the (1) at least one device user interface element and/or (2) at least one device user interface functionality based, at least in part, on data and/or information resulting from one or any combination of methods or processes disclosed in this application as relevant to any embodiment of the invention, and/or at least one signal resulting from one or any combination of methods (or processes) disclosed in this application as relevant to any embodiment of the invention.

(11) For various example embodiments of the invention, the following is also applicable: a method comprising creating and/or modifying (1) at least one device user interface element and/or (2) at least one device user interface functionality, the (1) at least one device user interface element and/or (2) at least one device user interface functionality based at least in part on data and/or information resulting from one or any combination of methods (or processes) disclosed in this application as relevant to any embodiment of the invention, and/or at least one signal resulting from one or any combination of methods (or processes) disclosed in this application as relevant to any embodiment of the invention.

(12) In various example embodiments, the methods (or processes) can be accomplished on the service provider side or on the mobile device side or in any shared way between service provider and mobile device with actions being performed on both sides.

(13) For various example embodiments, the following is applicable: An apparatus comprising means for performing a method of the claims.

(14) Still other aspects, features, and advantages of the invention are readily apparent from the following detailed description, simply by illustrating a number of particular embodiments and implementations, including the best mode contemplated for carrying out the invention. The invention is also capable of other and different embodiments, and its several details can be

modified in various obvious respects, all without departing from the spirit and scope of the invention. Accordingly, the drawings and description are to be regarded as illustrative in nature, and not as restrictive.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The embodiments of the invention are illustrated by way of example, and not by way of limitation, in the figures of the accompanying drawings:
- (2) FIG. 1 is a diagram of a system capable of providing mock map data for map design validation and document, according to one embodiment;
- (3) FIGS. 2A-2C are diagrams of example rendered map images based on mock map data, according to one embodiment;
- (4) FIG. 3 is a diagram of the components of a mock map data server, according to one embodiment;
- (5) FIG. 4 is a flowchart of a process for providing mock map data for map design validation and document, according to one embodiment;
- (6) FIGS. 5A-5G are diagrams of example map style taxonomy charts, according to one embodiment;
- (7) FIGS. 6A-6C are diagrams of example geometric arrangements for rendering mock map data, according to one embodiment;
- (8) FIG. 7 is a diagram of a geographic database, according to one embodiment;
- (9) FIG. 8 is a diagram of hardware that can be used to implement an embodiment of the invention;
- (10) FIG. 9 is a diagram of a chip set that can be used to implement an embodiment of the invention; and
- (11) FIG. 10 is a diagram of a mobile terminal (e.g., handset) that can be used to implement an embodiment of the invention.

DESCRIPTION OF SOME EMBODIMENTS

- (12) Examples of a method, apparatus, and computer program for providing mock map data for map design validation and document are disclosed. In the following description, for the purposes of explanation, numerous specific details are set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of the embodiments of the invention. It is apparent, however, to one skilled in the art that the embodiments of the invention may be practiced without these specific details or with an equivalent arrangement. In other instances, well-known structures and devices are shown in block diagram form in order to avoid unnecessarily obscuring the embodiments of the invention. Although the various embodiments are discussed with respect to a mapping or geographic database as one example of a structured database, it is contemplated that the embodiments described herein are applicable to any structured database that is to be streamed to user devices.
- (13) FIG. 1 is a diagram of a system capable of providing mock map data for map design validation and document, according to one embodiment. As noted above, in one embodiment, map rendering is a process where source map data (e.g., vector map data of a geographic database **101**) is transformed into a bitmap image of a map (e.g., map image **103**). By way of example, the source map data of the geographic database **101** is typically represented in form of vector tiles or equivalent representation. A vector tile contains cartographic or map features (e.g., roads, points of interest (POIs), political boundaries, terrain features, etc.) located within a geographic area represented by a given map tile at varying zoom levels. Each cartographic or map feature has an associated geometry, e.g., can be point, line, area, volume, etc. and a set of attributes.
- (14) In one embodiment, a cartography design team (e.g., design experts or a team of experts) can style the rendered appearance of the map (e.g., as rendered in the map image **103** by a map client

105) by assigning appearance or visual attributes (e.g., line width, color, outline, cap style, font properties, zoom level display, symbol, textures, shapes, etc.) to cartographic/map features based on the feature type and feature attribute values (e.g., functional class of a road, population of city, use of an urban area, etc.). The style, for instance, can be stored in a map style taxonomy **107** or equivalent data store that record the assigned stylistics rules with the corresponding cartographic/map features. Generally, the number of different appearances, styled based on feature attributes, can be very large. For example, streets stored in the geographic database **101** according to in a default or typical scheme can have more than 1,000 possible different appearances—e.g., based on all possible combinations of line widths, colors, outlines, cap styles, font properties, zoom level displays, etc. which are selected based on feature attributes such as road functional class, feature type (e.g., tunnel, bridge, etc.), surface type, and/or any other related attributes (e.g., under-construction, closed, etc.).

(15) Historically, map styling has been an interactive process that involves, for instance, changing the style or appearance of a map and then observing results using real map data. For example, if the size of a font for labeling a city with a population over 1,000,000 residents is changed, then a real-world city that meets this characteristic would have to be found in the real-world map data (e.g., by querying the geographic database **101** via a mapping platform **109**). The corresponding map tile from the geographic database **101** in which the test city would then be served over a communication network **111** from the mapping platform **109** to the map client **105** to be rendered according to the updated style (e.g., updated map style taxonomy **107**). The resulting rendered map image can then be inspected to determine the effect of the style change. However, when multiple style changes or made of if multiple interactions of the changed style with existing styled features is to be evaluated, it may be not possible to see all the possible combinations of the feature appearances and their interactions in one real-world place—as the features can be scattered around the world such that all desired test features are not co-located within the same map tile. Sometimes, the feature attributes are newly created and are not available in the existing real-world map data yet.

(16) In one example, test map data which includes all possible combinations of feature attributes can be drawn and attributed manually in a map editor. Such custom map source can be than used instead of normal base map vector tiles to style the map. However, the fact that map is manually edited makes it very difficult to modify and extend: a single new attribute, e.g., may require all the entries in the manually edited map data to be duplicated and amended with new attribute values, and that is an exponential amount of manual work for every new attribute. Styling also considers map scale, so the same data would have to be repeated at different scales or map zoom levels.

(17) In yet another example, a taxonomy chart can be created in design tools to visualize all the possible feature combinations. However, since there is historically no automated tool to generate the taxonomy chart from map styling descriptions, the process of creating a taxonomy chart must be done manually, which means it is prone to mistakes, and very labor intensive to maintain. Therefore, it cannot be used as a basis for interactive styling.

(18) To address these technical challenges, the system **100** of FIG. **1** introduces a capability to let a user specify a set of possible feature attributes and attribute values (e.g., all or a subset of available feature attributes and/or attribute values). Based on the input (e.g., feature attributes/values **113**), possible combinations of attribute values are calculated (e.g., by a mock map data server **115**). For each combination, a new geometric feature is procedurally created as, for instance, mock tile data **117**. The mock tile data **117** can be procedurally generated on demand, and/or stored or cached in a mock map database **119** for later use or re-use. In one embodiment, the mock tile data **117** can be stored in the mock map database **119** for map style taxonomy document at different points in time. As used herein, the term “procedurally generated” refers to synthetically generating map data based on the feature attributes/values **113** using one or more preconfigured rules to automatically arrange the geometric features representing the feature attributes and values specified in the feature attributes/values input **113** over a specified geographic area (e.g., a map tile or multiple map tiles

depending on the requested scale and/or density of the features. In one embodiment, the features are arranged in geometrical patterns (e.g., regular grids, columns, rows, strips, concentric circles, etc.) so that all combinations and intersections can be viewed in a compact area. The geometrical patterns generally result in intersecting arrangements of all combinations of the features (e.g., intersecting grid patterns). This, in turn, enables a user to quickly view the corresponding styled representations of the intersecting features in a compact area to document and/or validate whether the representations are visually compatible (e.g., do not blend in with each, remain visually distinct, create a pleasing color combination, etc.). The mock tile data **117** of the mock map database **119** with procedural geometry can be generated for all the locations in the world, and/or for all the zoom levels (or for specific locations or zoom levels specified by the user).

(19) In one embodiment, the procedural generator (e.g., the mock map data server **115**) can act as map data server (e.g., a vector tile server), so any client that supports the mock tile data **117** of the mock map database **119** can connect to the server **115** and render corresponding map images **103** (e.g., bitmap images) from the mock tile data **117**. By way of example, the mock map database **119** and the mock tile data **117** can be provided using any known or equivalent vector tile format (e.g., Mapbox Vector Tile (MVT), Optimized Map for Visualization (OMV), or equivalent). Accordingly, any compatible map client **105** (e.g., consumer application of vector maps) can connect to the mock map data sever **115** to receive and render the mock tile data **117** (e.g., rendered based on the map style taxonomy **107**). Examples of compatible map clients **105** include any vector-based map renderer such as, but are not limited to: HARP (HERE Advanced Rendering Platform) native, harp.gl, MapLab, MapBox, Tangram Rendering Engine or equivalent.

(20) According to the various embodiments, the system **100** is capable of procedurally generating combinations of available feature attributes and view the styled results as any other map (e.g., map image **103**) in any map editor or map client **105**. In addition, new attributes can easily be added or removed even if those attributes are not yet present in the available real-world map data (e.g., the geographic database **101**).

(21) FIGS. 2A-2C are diagrams of example rendered map images based on mock map data, according to one embodiment. In example map image **201** of FIG. 2A, the map client **105** has rendered a map image **201** of mock tile data **117** using a specified map style taxonomy **107**. The mock tile data **117** has been procedurally generated to include road features of varying attribute values (e.g., highway trunk, major primary road, major secondary road, major tertiary road, minor unclassified road, minor service road, minor residential road, pedestrian path, and footway path) against bridge features of varying attributes (e.g., highway trunk bridge, major primary road bridge, major secondary road bridge, major tertiary road bridge, minor unclassified road bridge, and minor service road bridge). The mock map data server **115** has arranged the road features of varying attributes as equally spaced vertical lines in a grid arrangement with the bridge features of varying attributes as equally spaced horizontal lines. The mock tile data **117** thus includes all possible intersection combinations of the road attributes and the bridge attributes so that the map image **201** can document and visually present the combinations based on the selected style taxonomy **107**.

(22) Once rendered as the map image **201**, the styled combinations (e.g., intersections of roads and bridges) can be visually documented and/or validated to determine whether a designer should change any to the styles to improve or alter the rendered appearance of the features. As a result, the designer or user need not search the real-world map data of the geographic database **101** for locations that where such intersections may occur, but instead can view a compact concentration of the procedurally generated intersection combinations for improved validation and document.

Because the mock tile data **117** is generated in a standard format supported by general map clients **115**, the map image **201** can be generated by the map client **105** without needing to be customized or modified (e.g., other than being able to be redirected to receive tile data from the mock map data server **115** instead of a non-mock tile server (e.g., the mapping platform **109** serving real world tiles from the geographic database **101**). This can also provide for interactivity with the mock tile data

117 using native functions of the map client **105** such as, but not limited, to changing map zoom levels, panning, etc. In one embodiment, the rendered map image **201** can serve as the equivalent of a map style taxonomy chart to document a created map style taxonomy **107** with the technical advantage that the map image **201** can be generated automatically without manual intervention unlike a traditional style taxonomy chart. For example, the rendered map image **201** can be exported to different file formats (e.g., PDF, JPG, TIFF, DOCX, PPTX, etc.) for creating a map style taxonomy document.

(23) It is noted that the grid arrangement of FIG. 2A is provided by way of illustration and not as a limitation. It is contemplated that the mock tile data **117** can be generated to present road features and/or any other map features available in the mock map database **119** and/or geographic database **101** according to any type of arrangement or pattern. FIG. 2B illustrates an example map image **211** that is a rendering of mock tile data **117** in which the road features are procedurally arranged in a concentric circular arrangement. More specifically, the concentric circular road features are overlaid on a vertically spaced arrangement of other road features. This arrangement is then further overlaid on horizontally arranged geographic areas with different land use categories (e.g., indicated by different horizontal bands with different shading—with each shade corresponding to a different land use category). By using different arrangements of features (e.g., circular versus grid—or another other arrangement), a map designer can view, validate, and/or document map style taxonomies across different possible geographic scenarios.

(24) FIG. 2C illustrates an example map image **221** that is rendered in three-dimensions, according to another embodiment. In the example of FIG. 2C, a user has selected the feature attributes/values of buildings of varying heights to be combined with land use of varying categories (e.g., beach, military, park, industrial). The mock map data server **115** generates mock tile data **117** that arranges vector representations of buildings from tallest to shortest building in a vertical line that repeat as horizontally. The buildings are placed on different land use areas arranged horizontally underneath the buildings from “BEACH” to “MILITARY” to “PARK” to “INDUSTRIAL.” The visual appearance of the buildings and land use areas can be individually style (e.g., different 3D heights for building models, different land use color/shading for each land use). The arrangement is encoded in standard vector tile format as mock tile data **117** and sent to the map client **105** for rendering using a selected map style taxonomy **107**. As with the example of FIG. 2A, the procedurally generated mock tile data **117** used to render the map image **211** can depict buildings and land use areas that do not occur in the real-world map data of the geographic database **101**. This enables a designer to document and validate the styled features using the map image **211** in an automated way that would otherwise require extensive manual map editing or taxonomy chart creation.

(25) The various embodiments of procedurally generating mock map data for map design validation and/or document provide for several use causes including but not limited to the following: For a cartographer/designer/style editor user case, the various embodiments enable a user to: create a map style concept (e.g., map style taxonomy **107**); validate the created style for completeness and sanity check; and visually document the created map style in one view.

(26) This use case is possible through: A visual overview of every selected map object (e.g., cartographic or map feature) and their attributes (and combinations thereof) in a rendered map image **103** that the user can customize (e.g., by specifying different visual characteristics such as, but not limited to, area, line, point, volumes, labels, icons, etc.). The ability to relate visual variables selected by the user for the map objects in relation to each other in one view (e.g., visual variables such as, but not limited to, size, color, hue saturation value (HSV), shape, texture, etc.). The ability to add new map features to the style taxonomy even if the new map features do not currently exist in current real-world map data.

(27) FIG. 3 is a diagram of the components of a mock map data server, according to one embodiment. In one embodiment, as shown in FIG. 3, the mock map data server **115** of the system

100 includes one or more components for providing mock map data for map design validation and documentation according to the various embodiments described herein. It is contemplated that the functions of the components of the mock map data server **115** may be combined or performed by other components of equivalent functionality. As shown, in one embodiment, the mock map data server **115** includes the following components: A feature module **301** to generate possible combinations of cartographic/map feature attributes and attribute values (e.g., the feature attributes and attribute values can be selected by a user or by any other process); A geometry module **303** to generate geometric features based on the combination of features attributes/values and arrange the geometric features in different patterns/arrangements inside a designated geographic area (e.g., a map tile or multiple tiles in case the number of features is too big for a single tile); A data generation module **305** (e.g., vector module) to create map data based on the arranged geometric that is compatible with the data accepted by a target map client **105** (e.g., a wrapper around MVT specification protobuf generated file (or equivalent vector format such as but not limited to OMV), which enables the procedural creation of mock tile data **117** as compatible vector tiles (e.g., MVT or other format compatible tiles) comprising points, lines, and areas with an arbitrary set of attributes to the tile and at one or more arbitrary map zoom levels, locations, etc.; and A data server **307** (e.g., an output module) which can be a HTTP server (or equivalent) that servers the procedurally generated mock tile data **117** to any compatible and connected map client **105** (e.g., map clients **105** supporting MVT, OMV, etc. map tiles).

(28) The above presented modules and components of the mock map data server **115** can be implemented in hardware, firmware, software, or a combination thereof. For example, in one embodiment, the mock map data server **115** and/or any of its components can be implemented as a set of Python modules with functions to procedurally generate and serve mock map data to compatible map clients **105**.

(29) Though depicted as a separate entity in FIG. **1**, it is contemplated that the mock map data server **115** may be implemented as a module of any of the components of the system **100** (e.g., a component of the mapping platform **109** or other device, service, or application with connectivity to the system **100**). In another embodiment, one or more of the modules **301-307** may be implemented as a cloud-based service, local service, native application, or combination thereof. The functions of the mock map data server **115** and modules **301-307** are discussed with respect to the figures below.

(30) FIG. **4** is a flowchart of a process for providing mock map data for map design validation and document, according to one embodiment. In various embodiments, the mock map data server **115** and/or any of the modules **301-307** may perform one or more portions of the process **400** and may be implemented in, for instance, a chip set including a processor and a memory as shown in FIG. **9**. As such, the mock map data server **115** and/or any of the modules **301-307** can provide means for accomplishing various parts of the process **400**, as well as means for accomplishing embodiments of other processes described herein in conjunction with other components of the system **100**. Although the process **400** is illustrated and described as a sequence of steps, it is contemplated that various embodiments of the process **400** may be performed in any order or combination and need not include all of the illustrated steps.

(31) By way of example, the various embodiments of the process **400**, the mock map data server **115**, and modules **301-307** can be applicable to various uses including but not limited to: By cartographic designers, to test styling of different combinations of features and attributes; To perform exhaustive functional testing including edge cases which are uncommon in real maps; and For performance testing by creating high quantities of features, geometry, or complex geometry.

(32) A technical advantage of the various embodiments of the mock map data server **115** described herein as compared to other mock approaches, is that the procedurally generated mock tile data **117** can be used by any application (e.g., any map client **105**) capable of consuming the mock tile data **117** (e.g., MVT, OMV, or equivalent map tiles) without modification apart from providing a

different server endpoint.

(33) In one embodiment, the mock map data generation in the various embodiment of process **400** is procedural. This enables the mock map data server **115** to generate large quantities of various combinations of geometries and attributes that are arranged in patterns that are suited for map style validation, documentation, and comparison when real-world feature geometries are not needed.

(34) Although the various embodiments of the process **400** is described below with respect to implementation of the mock map data server **115** using Python modules, it is contemplated the mock map data server **115** may be implemented using any equivalent module, hardware, software, firmware, circuitry, etc.

(35) In step **401**, the feature module **301** calculates one or more combinations of one or more map feature attributes, one or more map feature attribute values, or a combination thereof to initiate the process **400** for generating mock map data (e.g., mock tile data **117**). As previously described the features can be cartographic or map features (e.g., roads, bridges, POIs, terrain, land use categories) included in the geographic database **101** or equivalent digital map data. Depending on the specific type of feature, each feature can have varying attributes. For example, roads can have feature attributes such as but not limited to functional class, road surface, number of lanes, supported traffic types, etc. Then each feature attribute can have different values. For example, the feature attribute of a function class of a road can have values such as but not limited to functional class 1, functional class 2, functional class 3, etc. As a result, when multiple feature attributes and/or respective attribute values are selected, the number of possible combinations of feature attributes and values can quickly grow.

(36) In one embodiment, the feature attributes and attribute values that are to be processed to generate mock tile data **117** or mock map data in general can be specified by a user. For example, the mock map data server **115** can present a user interface to the user for selecting location data, map data, map feature catalogs, etc. from which the feature attributes and attribute values can be selected. In one embodiment, the user may have access to a reduced set of location data, map data, map feature catalogs, etc. The set may be reduced due, for instance, to access rights, purchased/licensed features, geographic restrictions, etc. During a map design session, the platform user may start with a full selection of the features available to the platform user, de-select some of the features, or start with a blank set and add desired features. In one embodiment, the user interface may provide easy selection of the features, feature attributes, attribute values, and/or feature categories by using tick boxes, search input, radio buttons, and/or any other equivalent user interface element.

(37) The user, for instance, can provide as input one or more attribute lists that specify the feature attributes of interest and/or attribute values. For example, referring back to the example of FIG. 2A, the user can provide a first attribute list for road functional class that lists the following attribute values: highway trunk (HT), major primary road (MPR), major secondary road (MSR), major tertiary road (MTR), minor unclassified road (MUR), minor service road (MvR), minor residential road (MRR), pedestrian path (PP), and footway path (FP). Then, the user can also provide a second attribute list for bridge function class that lists the following values: highway trunk bridge (HTB), major primary road bridge (MPRB), major secondary road bridge (MSRB), major tertiary road bridge (MTRB), minor unclassified road bridge (MURB), and minor service road bridge (MvRB).

(38) Based on the input above, the feature module **301** can determine possible combinations of the attribute lists provided by the user. In one embodiment, a combinations Python module is provided and enables the feature module **301** to create all attribute value combinations from user defined attribute names and attribute values belonging to each name. The following is an example use of the combinations Python module:

(39) Attribute a has two possible values:

(40) TABLE-US-00001 >>> combinations({"a": [1, 2]}) [{ 'a': 1}, { 'a': 2}]

(41) Two attributes, a and b, are provided, each with two possible values:

A horizontal strip (horizontalStrips): as shown FIG. 5D, each attribute set creates a new horizontal strip area feature (e.g., horizontal strip areas **531a-531d**—also collectively referred to as horizontal strips **531**), and horizontal strips **531** are stacked on top of another; A vertical strip (verticalStrips): as shown in FIG. 5E, each attribute set creates a new vertical strip area feature (e.g., vertical strip areas **541a-541d**—also collectively referred to as vertical strips **541**), and vertical strips **541** are put next to another; and A rectangle grid (rectangleGrid): as shown in example rectangle grid **551** of FIG. 5F, each attribute set creates a new rectangle area feature (e.g., area **553a-553i**—also collectively referred to as rectangle areas **553**), and the rectangle areas **553** are laid out into a grid **551**.

(50) In one embodiment, the user can provide two or more lists of attributes sets. In this case, a cartesian product of the lists can be generated with one feature for each combination of feature sets from the first attribute list and the second attribute list. The resulting feature combinations can be organized into a grid (or other two-dimensional/multi-dimensional representation) in comparison to a single attribute list which can be presented using one dimension. FIG. 5G illustrates an example map image **561** depicting a cartesian product. In the example of FIG. 5G, one dimension of the cartesian product has different functional classes of a road (e.g., which affects the shading of the visual representation of the road), and another dimension has closure status of the road which determines whether the visual representation of road is a solid line (e.g., indicating a road is open to traffic) or a dashed line (e.g., indicating a road is closed to traffic). Another example of a cartesian product is in the previously discussed FIG. 2C. In the example of FIG. 2C, one dimension of the cartesian product has different building heights, and another dimension has different building types which influence the rendered color of its visual representation.

(51) Other general examples of cartesian product representations include but are not limited to: A cartesian product point grid (cartesianProductPointGrid): point features in a grid (e.g., similar to the example of FIG. 5A but with multiple feature attributes); A cartesian product line grid (cartesianProductLineGrid): line feature for each cell of a grid (e.g., similar to the example of FIG. 2A). A cartesian product rectangle grid (cartesianProductRectangleGrid): rectangle feature for each grid cell (e.g., similar to the examples of FIGS. 2B and 5F but with multiple feature attributes).

(52) In one embodiment, the geometry module **303** can use a layout function to determine the arrangement of geometric features based on additional parameters. Examples of these additional parameter include but are not limited to: A countPerTile/countPerDimension parameter specifies the number of features per tile width/height or other geographic area dimension (e.g., x distance and y distance of a geographic in meters). This parameter controls how densely the selected features are procedurally packed in a given tile or designated geographic area of the mock map data. In case there are too many features to fit into a tile or geographic at the specified count, additional tiles (e.g., adjacent below/above or to the right/left of the current tile) are reserved to contain the overflow features. When countPerTile is 1, each feature will have a separate tile. A gap parameter controls the gap between the features in the arrangement. For example, in one embodiment, the range for this parameter can be [0,1] with 0 indicating that the features are touching and 1 indicating that the feature is the maximum set distance apart (e.g., 1 map tile apart).

(53) In one embodiment, the geometry module **303** can build functions for arranging different types of feature attribute combinations based on the above geometric arrangements and parameters. For example, a function to arrange land use attributes (e.g., in which geographic areas with different land uses can be colored or style different such as green indicating park areas, pink indicating hospital areas, gray indicating industrial areas, etc.) can use the rectangleGrid module arrange rectangular areas corresponding to different land use attribute values in a grid pattern. Alternatively the land use function (e.g., mock_landuse.py Python function) can be modified to use horizontalStrips and/or verticalStrips instead.

(54) In step **407**, after the geometric features of the feature combinations and their arrangements are determined, the data generation module **305** generates the data in the mock map database **119** (e.g.,

mock tile data 117) based on the arrangement. More specifically, in one embodiment, the data generation module 305 encodes the geometric features and their arrangement into vector-based map tiles in a standard format (e.g., MVT, OMV, or any other map data format known in the art) that is compatible with target map clients 105.

(55) In one embodiment, as part of the tile encoding process, a Protobuf compiler generated file vector_tile_pb2.py (based on Mapbox Vector Tile Specification vector_tile.proto) is wrapped by vector_tile module. Table 2 below illustrates the Mapbox vector tile specification.

(56) TABLE-US-00005 TABLE 2 package vector_tile; option optimize_for = LITE_RUNTIME;

```
message Tile { // GeomType is described in section 4.3.4 of the specification enum
  GeomType { UNKNOWN = 0; POINT = 1; LINESTRING = 2;
  POLYGON = 3; } // Variant type encoding // The use of values is described in
section 4.1 of the specification message Value { // Exactly one of these values
must be present in a valid message optional string string_value = 1; optional
float float_value = 2; optional double double_value = 3; optional int64
int_value = 4; optional uint64 uint_value = 5; optional sint64 sint_value = 6;
optional bool bool_value = 7; extensions 8 to max; } // Features are
described in section 4.2 of the specification message Feature { optional uint64 id = 1
[ default = 0 ]; // Tags of this feature are encoded as repeated pairs of //
integers. // A detailed description of tags is located in sections // 4.2 and 4.4 of
the specification repeated uint32 tags = 2 [ packed = true ]; // The type of
geometry stored in this feature. optional GeomType type = 3 [ default = UNKNOWN ];
// Contains a stream of commands and parameters (vertices). // A detailed
description on geometry encoding is located in // section 4.3 of the specification.
repeated uint32 geometry = 4 [ packed = true ]; } // Layers are described in
section 4.1 of the specification message Layer { // Any compliant implementation
must first read the version // number encoded in this message and choose the correct
// implementation for this version number before proceeding to // decode
other parts of this message. required uint32 version = 15 [ default = 1 ];
required string name = 1; // The actual features in this tile. repeated Feature
features = 2; // Dictionary encoding for keys repeated string keys = 3;
// Dictionary encoding for values repeated Value values = 4; //
Although this is an “optional” field it is required by the specification. // See
https://github.com/mapbox/vector-tile-spec/issues/47 optional uint32 extent = 5 [
default = 4096 ]; extensions 16 to max; } repeated Layer layers = 3;
extensions 16 to 8191; }
```

(57) The module implements geometry and attribute encoding specified by the vector tile specification. By way of example, it has two classes to help populate tile with mock map data content: Layer and Tile. Layer represents a vector tile layer. A single tile can contain multiple layers. Each Layer can in turn contain multiple features. Features are added by functions: addPoint, add Line, and addArea. Each of these functions accepts a list of coordinates and a dictionary with attributes. The coordinates and attributes to add is based on the selected feature attributes and attributes along with the geometric features corresponding to each combination of feature attributes and attribute values and the determined arrangement of those features.

(58) In one embodiment, the coordinates are represented by an (x, y) tuple. The range of coordinate values is [0, 1] normalized to the extent of a map tile or equivalent designated geographic area (or equivalent coordinate system). In one embodiment, the mock map data is generated at one or more map zoom levels such that the corresponding geographic extent of the map tile can depend on the selected zoom level. Values out of this range can be used as well. In that case, the geometry of the corresponding feature stretches beyond the tile border. An example of this coordinate representation is as follows:

(59) TABLE-US-00006 # A diagonal line through the extent of the tile points = [(0,0),(1,1)]

(60) Attributes is a dictionary of attributes associated with the feature. An example of example specifying attributes is as follows:

(61) TABLE-US-00007 attributes = {"name": "feature name", "kind": "feature kind"}

(62) A Tile object represents a vector tile. A new layer is added to a tile by calling add Layer. Since there can be only one layer for a specific layer name, an existing layer is returned if add Layer is called multiple times with the same layerName parameter. After all the layers have been added, the serialize function generates a corresponding tile binary blob (e.g., the mock tile data **117**). An example of this process is as follows:

(63) TABLE-US-00008 layer = Layer("pois") layer.addPoint([(10, 20)], {"name": "a point", "some other attribute": "other value"}) # ... add more/different geometry tile = Tile() tile.addLayer(layer) # ... add more layers tile.serialize()

(64) In one embodiment, the vector_tile module can be used directly. However, use of the vector_tile module in combination with some common tile content generation patterns of the layout module can be used. Feature generation with the layout module provides a way to automatically and procedurally generate geometric features based on user provided sets of attributes as described above with respect to the various embodiments of steps **401-403**. For example, the layout module uses respective geometry modules (e.g., pointGrid, horizontalLines, verticalLines, horizontalStrips, verticalStrips, rectangleGrid, cartesianProductPointGrid, cartesianProductLineGrid, cartesianProductRectangleGrid,) along with layout parameters (e.g., countPerTile/countPerDimension, and gap) to automatically arrange various combinations of feature attributes and attributes values in patterns for to generate the data in the mock map database **119** (e.g., mock tile data **117**).

(65) In step **409**, the data server **307** provides the data in the mock map database **119** (e.g., the mock tile data **117**) to a map client **105**. In one embodiment, the data server **307** can be a simple HTTP server calling one or more of the mock map data generator functions (as described in the various embodiments above) with a requested row, column, and level (e.g., map zoom level) of a mock map data tile. The corresponding data in the mock map database **119**, for instance, can be provided over a communication network **111** to the requesting map client **105** (e.g., a mapping application or map editor that supports the data format of the mock map database **119**—such as the data format of real-world map data of the geographic database **101**). In one embodiment, the map client **105** can be redirected to receive map data from the mock map data server **115** instead of the mapping platform **109** that provides real-world map data from the geographic database **101** (e.g., because the data of the mock map database **119** is generated in a map data format compatible with real-world map data already used by the map client **105**). This can be performed, for instance, by modifying the server URL configured in the map client **105** to the URL of the mock map data server **115**.

(66) After the map client **105** receives the requested mock tile data **117** (e.g., containing procedurally generated combinations of feature attributes and values arranged in a compact pattern according to the various embodiments described herein), the map client **105** can render the mock tile data **117** (e.g., provided from the mock map database **119** as vector-based map data) in a map image **103** (e.g., bitmap image for presenting in a mapping user interface or display of a device) based on a map style taxonomy **107**.

(67) In one embodiment, the map style taxonomy **107** assigns one or more visual attributes (e.g., appearance styles such as but not limited to different line width, color, outline, cap style, font properties, zoom level display, symbol, textures, shapes, etc.) respectively to the one or more map feature attributes, the one or more map feature attribute values, the one or more combinations of the features, or a combination thereof. In this way, the one or more visual attributes are rendered in the map image to represent the one or more map feature attributes, the one or more map feature attribute values, the one or more combinations, or a combination thereof. In other words, a style

taxonomy may specify how each feature is styled when rendered in an image for display. By changing part or all of the style taxonomy, the look and feel of the resulting rendered map data can be changed. Because there can be potentially hundreds or more different features and exponentially more combinations of those features, the map style taxonomy can be a complex hierarchy of features and corresponding appearance. This is especially true, when the appearance of features can change with varying zoom levels (e.g., feature sizes, color, line widths, etc.) applied to the map data.

(68) Because the data in the mock map database **119** (e.g., the mock tile data **117**) is procedurally generated, the resulting rendered map image **103** can more compactly depict cartographic features that may be difficult to find in one real-world map tile. In addition, new cartographic features that have not been labeled or represented in existing real-world map data can nonetheless be included in the procedurally generated mock tile data **117** (e.g., as optionally stored in the mock map database **119**). In other words, the one or more map feature attributes, the one or more map feature attribute values, or a combination thereof selected for generating the mock tile data **117** or other equivalent map data of the mock map database **119** may not be currently represented or exist in real-world map data (e.g., the geographic database **101**). In this way, designs for new features can be completed and tested before those features are placed into production map data.

(69) The systematic and orderly arrangement of different combinations of selected map features also enable map designers to quickly validate whether their map design choices are visually appealing across a wide range of scenarios without have to query and discover real-world locations with equivalent combinations. In other embodiments, the map images **103** rendered by the map clients **105** using mock tile data **117** or any other map data of the mock map database **119** can be provided as an output that visually documents the map style taxonomy used to render the image **103**. In this way, manual creation of map style taxonomy charts can be avoided.

(70) FIGS. **6A-6C** illustrate additional examples of map images **103** rendered from mock tile data **117** or any other map data of mock map database **119** generated based on various feature attribute lists, according to various embodiments. The example rendered map image **601** of FIG. **6A** illustrates roads and railways against land use based on a selected style taxonomy. More specifically, the feature attributes selected for generating the corresponding mock tile data **117** or other equivalent map data of the mock map database **119** includes a first attribute list of road/railway classes (e.g., with attribute values of highway, major road primary, major road secondary, major road tertiary, minor road residential, path pedestrian, path footway, rail, and ferry) and a second attribute list of land use categories for the land on which the road/railways are located (e.g., with attribute values of beach, airfield, university, military, glacier, pedestrian, national park, cemetery, golf course, park, forest, industrial, and hospital). The mock map data server **115** used a vertical line arrange to represent roads/railways overlaid on a horizontal strip arrangement of the land use categories. As map image **601** illustrates, this orderly arrangement enables a compact view of all possible combinations of the road/railway types against the land use categories. For example, the grid arrangement of linear features causes all features to intersect with each other, allowing a user to determine if different style choices collide with each other across a range of feature combinations. In addition, because the map image **601** is rendered in a map client **105** that supports zooming to different map levels, the designer can interactively change zoom levels to validate or document how the style of the map may also change. Validate, in this case, refers to an enabling the designer or user to visually inspect design elements to ensure it is the design intended by the designer (e.g., whether any features become inadvertently invisible or difficult to see based on design choices—such as selected the same or similar colors for background versus text, etc.).

(71) The example rendered map image **611** of FIG. **6B** illustrates a road and railways against administrative lines. In this example, the combination of road/railway feature attributes against administrative line attributes are generated in the corresponding mock tile data **117** or other equivalent map data of the mock map database **119** as a line grid with horizontal lines representing

different road/railway attribute values and vertical lines representing different administrative lines. As with the example of FIG. 6B, this line grid representation of feature combinations enables a user to quickly view or document the map design of the roads/railways against administrative lines in a compact area. Because the line grid is procedurally generated by the mock map data server **115**, no manual editing or creating of map data is needed to produce the mock map tile data **117** or equivalent map data of the mock map database **119** and resulting map image **611**. As a result, the various embodiments described herein provided for several technical advantages including but not limited to automated production of the mock tile data **117** or other equivalent map data of the mock map database **119**, increased speed of validating/documenting map designs, and reduction of manual resources.

(72) The example rendered map image **621** of FIG. 6C illustrates a point grid arrangement of different points of interest with their respective stylized symbols. In this example, the attribute list specifies different types of points of interest (e.g., coffee shops, music stores, bars, scenic locations, and work locations). The corresponding mock tile data **117** or other equivalent map data of the mock map database **119** was generated so that the locations of the different POI types are arranged in a grid pattern. In this way, the symbols specified for each POI type in the corresponding style taxonomy can be viewed and documented in a compact area.

(73) Returning to FIG. 1, in one embodiment, the mock map data server **115** has connectivity or access to a mock map database **119** that includes mock mapping data (e.g., mock tile data **117** or other map data format) generated according to the various embodiments described herein. In addition, the system **100** includes a mapping platform **109** (e.g., a non-mock map data server) with connectivity to the geographic database **101** that provides real-world or production map data. The mock map database **119** is equivalent to the geographic database **101** but instead store mock map data instead of or in addition to real-world data. Thus both support the same map format (e.g., vector-based formats such as MVT, OMV, or equivalent) and include or otherwise support a tile projection of the map data. In one embodiment, the mock map database **119** and the geographic database **101** can be included in the same database (e.g., either all in the mock map database **119** or all in the geographic database **101**) or be included in any other equivalent digital map data store.

(74) In one embodiment, the map client **105** (e.g., an application executing on a device) has connectivity to the mock map data server **115** and/or the mapping platform **109** to receive mock map data (e.g., mock tile data **117** or other equivalent map data of the mock map database **119**) for rendering according to the various embodiments described herein. For example, the map client **105** can be otherwise include a mapping application (e.g., map editor) and/or any other location-based application that can act as a client to the mock map data server **115**. By way of example, the map client **105** can be executed on or is any type of embedded system, mobile terminal, fixed terminal, or portable terminal including a built-in navigation system, a personal navigation device, mobile handset, station, unit, device, multimedia computer, multimedia tablet, Internet node, communicator, desktop computer, laptop computer, notebook computer, netbook computer, tablet computer, personal communication system (PCS) device, personal digital assistants (PDAs), audio/video player, digital camera/camcorder, positioning device, fitness device, television receiver, radio broadcast receiver, electronic book device, game device, or any combination thereof, including the accessories and peripherals of these devices, or any combination thereof.

(75) It is also contemplated that the map client **105** can support any type of interface to the user (such as “wearable” circuitry, etc.). In one embodiment, the map client **105** may be associated with a vehicle (e.g., cars), a component part of the vehicle, a mobile device (e.g., phone), and/or a combination of thereof. Similarly, the vehicle and/or mobile device may include computing components that can perform all or a portion of the functions of the map client **105**. By way of example, the map client **105** may include any type of application such as vehicle control application, mapping application, location-based service applications, navigation applications, content provisioning services, camera/imaging application, media player applications, social

networking applications, calendar applications, and the like. In one embodiment, the map client **105** may act as a client for the mock data server **115** and/or mapping platform **109** and perform one or more functions of either component alone or in combination with the mock data server **115** and/or mapping platform **109**.

(76) In one embodiment, the communication network **111** of system **100** includes one or more networks such as a data network, a wireless network, a telephony network, or any combination thereof. It is contemplated that the data network may be any local area network (LAN), metropolitan area network (MAN), wide area network (WAN), a public data network (e.g., the Internet), short range wireless network, or any other suitable packet-switched network, such as a commercially owned, proprietary packet-switched network, e.g., a proprietary cable or fiber-optic network, and the like, or any combination thereof. In addition, the wireless network may be, for example, a cellular network and may employ various technologies including enhanced data rates for global evolution (EDGE), general packet radio service (GPRS), global system for mobile communications (GSM), Internet protocol multimedia subsystem (IMS), universal mobile telecommunications system (UMTS), etc., as well as any other suitable wireless medium, e.g., worldwide interoperability for microwave access (WiMAX), Long Term Evolution (LTE) networks, code division multiple access (CDMA), wideband code division multiple access (WCDMA), wireless fidelity (Wi-Fi), wireless LAN (WLAN), Bluetooth®, Internet Protocol (IP) data casting, satellite, mobile ad-hoc network (MANET), and the like, or any combination thereof.

(77) In one embodiment, the mock data server **115** may be a platform with multiple interconnected components. The mock data server **115** may include multiple servers, intelligent networking devices, computing devices, components and corresponding software for providing mock map data according to the various embodiments described herein.

(78) By way of example, the map client **105**, mock map data server **115**, and mapping platform **109** communicate with each other and other components of the system **100** using well known, new or still developing protocols. In this context, a protocol includes a set of rules defining how the network nodes within the communication network **111** interact with each other based on information sent over the communication links. The protocols are effective at different layers of operation within each node, from generating and receiving physical signals of various types, to selecting a link for transferring those signals, to the format of information indicated by those signals, to identifying which software application executing on a computer system sends or receives the information. The conceptually different layers of protocols for exchanging information over a network are described in the Open Systems Interconnection (OSI) Reference Model.

(79) Communications between the network nodes are typically effected by exchanging discrete packets of data. Each packet typically comprises (1) header information associated with a particular protocol, and (2) payload information that follows the header information and contains information that may be processed independently of that particular protocol. In some protocols, the packet includes (3) trailer information following the payload and indicating the end of the payload information. The header includes information such as the source of the packet, its destination, the length of the payload, and other properties used by the protocol. Often, the data in the payload for the particular protocol includes a header and payload for a different protocol associated with a different, higher layer of the OSI Reference Model. The header for a particular protocol typically indicates a type for the next protocol contained in its payload. The higher layer protocol is said to be encapsulated in the lower layer protocol. The headers included in a packet traversing multiple heterogeneous networks, such as the Internet, typically include a physical (layer 1) header, a data-link (layer 2) header, an internetwork (layer 3) header and a transport (layer 4) header, and various application (layer 5, layer 6 and layer 7) headers as defined by the OSI Reference Model.

(80) FIG. 7 is a diagram of the geographic database **101** of system **100**, according to exemplary embodiments. In one embodiment, the description of the geographic database **101** provided herein is also applicable to the mock map database **119**. In some embodiment, the geographic database

101 can include the data that would otherwise be stored in the mock map database **119**.

(81) In one embodiment, the geographic database **101** include high definition (HD) mapping data that provide centimeter-level or better accuracy of map features. For example, the geographic database **101** can be based on Light Detection and Ranging (LiDAR) or equivalent technology to collect billions of 3D points and model road surfaces and other map features down to the number lanes and their widths. In one embodiment, the HD mapping data (e.g., HD data records **1011**) capture and store details such as the slope and curvature of the road, lane markings, roadside objects such as signposts, including what the signage denotes. By way of example, the HD mapping data enable highly automated vehicles to precisely localize themselves on the road.

(82) In one embodiment, geographic features (e.g., two-dimensional or three-dimensional features) are represented using polylines and/or polygons (e.g., two-dimensional features) or polygon extrusions (e.g., three-dimensional features). In one embodiment, these polylines/polygons can also represent ground truth or reference features or objects (e.g., signs, road markings, lane lines, landmarks, etc.) used for visual odometry. For example, the polylines or polygons can correspond to the boundaries or edges of the respective geographic features. In the case of a building, a two-dimensional polygon can be used to represent a footprint of the building, and a three-dimensional polygon extrusion can be used to represent the three-dimensional surfaces of the building. Accordingly, the terms polygons and polygon extrusions as used herein can be used interchangeably.

(83) In one embodiment, the following terminology applies to the representation of geographic features in the geographic database **101**.

(84) “Node”—A point that terminates a link.

(85) “Line segment”—A straight line connecting two points.

(86) “Link” (or “edge”)—A contiguous, non-branching string of one or more line segments terminating in a node at each end.

(87) “Shape point”—A point along a link between two nodes (e.g., used to alter a shape of the link without defining new nodes).

(88) “Oriented link”—A link that has a starting node (referred to as the “reference node”) and an ending node (referred to as the “non reference node”).

(89) “Simple polygon”—An interior area of an outer boundary formed by a string of oriented links that begins and ends in one node. In one embodiment, a simple polygon does not cross itself.

(90) “Polygon”—An area bounded by an outer boundary and none or at least one interior boundary (e.g., a hole or island). In one embodiment, a polygon is constructed from one outer simple polygon and none or at least one inner simple polygon. A polygon is simple if it just consists of one simple polygon, or complex if it has at least one inner simple polygon.

(91) In one embodiment, the geographic database **101** follows certain conventions. For example, links do not cross themselves and do not cross each other except at a node. Also, there are no duplicated shape points, nodes, or links. Two links that connect each other have a common node. In the geographic database **101**, overlapping geographic features are represented by overlapping polygons. When polygons overlap, the boundary of one polygon crosses the boundary of the other polygon. In the geographic database **101**, the location at which the boundary of one polygon intersects they boundary of another polygon is represented by a node. In one embodiment, a node may be used to represent other locations along the boundary of a polygon than a location at which the boundary of the polygon intersects the boundary of another polygon. In one embodiment, a shape point is not used to represent a point at which the boundary of a polygon intersects the boundary of another polygon.

(92) As shown, the geographic database **101** includes geographic data **701** used for (or configured to be compiled to be used for) mapping and/or navigation-related services, such as for personalized route determination, according to exemplary embodiments. For example, the geographic database **101** includes node data records **703**, road segment or link data records **705**, POI data records **707**,

mock map data records **709**, other records **711**, and indexes **713**. More, fewer or different data records can be provided. In one embodiment, additional data records (not shown) can include cartographic (“carto”) data records, routing data, and maneuver data. In one embodiment, the indexes **713** may improve the speed of data retrieval operations in the geographic database **101**. The indexes **713** may be used to quickly locate data without having to search every row in the geographic database **101** every time it is accessed.

(93) In exemplary embodiments, the road segment data records **705** are links or segments representing roads, streets, or paths, as can be used in the calculated route or recorded route information for determination of one or more personalized routes, according to exemplary embodiments. The node data records **703** are end points corresponding to the respective links or segments of the road segment data records **705**. The road link data records **705** and the node data records **703** represent a road network, such as used by vehicles, cars, and/or other entities. Alternatively, the geographic database **101** can contain path segment and node data records or other data that represent pedestrian paths or areas in addition to or instead of the vehicle road record data, for example.

(94) The road/link segments and nodes can be associated with attributes, such as geographic coordinates, street names, address ranges, speed limits, turn restrictions at intersections, and other navigation related attributes, as well as POIs, such as gasoline stations, hotels, restaurants, museums, stadiums, offices, automobile dealerships, auto repair shops, buildings, stores, parks, etc. The geographic database **101** can include data about the POIs and their respective locations in the POI data records **707**. The geographic database **101** can also include data about places, such as cities, towns, or other communities, and other geographic features, such as bodies of water, mountain ranges, etc. Such place or feature data can be part of the POI data records **707** or can be associated with POIs or POI data records **707** (such as a data point used for displaying or representing a position of a city).

(95) In one embodiment, the geographic database **101** is presented according to a hierarchical or multi-level tile projection. More specifically, in one embodiment, the geographic database **101** may be defined according to a normalized Mercator projection. Other projections may be used. By way of example, the map tile grid of a Mercator or similar projection is a multilevel grid. Each cell or tile in a level of the map tile grid is divisible into the same number of tiles of that same level of grid. In other words, the initial level of the map tile grid (e.g., a level at the lowest zoom level) is divisible into four cells or rectangles. Each of those cells are in turn divisible into four cells, and so on until the highest zoom or resolution level of the projection is reached.

(96) In one embodiment, the map tile grid may be numbered in a systematic fashion to define a tile identifier (tile ID). For example, the top left tile may be numbered 00, the top right tile may be numbered 01, the bottom left tile may be numbered 10, and the bottom right tile may be numbered 11. In one embodiment, each cell is divided into four rectangles and numbered by concatenating the parent tile ID and the new tile position. A variety of numbering schemes also is possible. Any number of levels with increasingly smaller geographic areas may represent the map tile grid. Any level (n) of the map tile grid has $2^{(n+1)}$ cells. Accordingly, any tile of the level (n) has a geographic area of $A/2^{(n+1)}$ where A is the total geographic area of the world or the total area of the map tile grid **10**. Because of the numbering system, the exact position of any tile in any level of the map tile grid or projection may be uniquely determined from the tile ID.

(97) In one embodiment, the system **100** may identify a tile by a quadkey determined based on the tile ID of a tile of the map tile grid. The quadkey, for example, is a one-dimensional array including numerical values. In one embodiment, the quadkey may be calculated or determined by interleaving the bits of the row and column coordinates of a tile in the grid at a specific level. The interleaved bits may be converted to a predetermined base number (e.g., base 10, base 4, hexadecimal). In one example, leading zeroes are inserted or retained regardless of the level of the map tile grid in order to maintain a constant length for the one-dimensional array of the quadkey. In

another example, the length of the one-dimensional array of the quadkey may indicate the corresponding level within the map tile grid **10**. In one embodiment, the quadkey is an example of the hash or encoding scheme of the respective geographical coordinates of a geographical data point that can be used to identify a tile in which the geographical data point is located.

(98) In one embodiment, the geographic database **101** can also include mock map data records **709** for storing the data of the mock map database **119** (e.g., mock tile data **117**) and/or any other related data that is used or generated according to the embodiments described herein. By way of example, the mock map data records **709** can be associated with one or more of the node records **703**, road segment records **705**, and/or POI data records **707** to associate the mock map data records **709** with specific places, POIs, geographic areas, and/or other map features. In this way, the mock map data records **709** can also be associated with the characteristics or metadata of the corresponding records **703**, **705**, and/or **707**.

(99) In one embodiment, the geographic database **101** can be maintained by a content provider in association with the services platform (e.g., a map developer). The map developer can collect geographic data to generate and enhance the geographic database **101**. There can be different ways used by the map developer to collect data. These ways can include obtaining data from other sources, such as municipalities or respective geographic authorities. In addition, the map developer can employ field personnel to travel by vehicle along roads throughout the geographic region to observe features and/or record information about them, for example. Also, remote sensing, such as aerial or satellite photography, can be used.

(100) The geographic database **101** can be a master geographic database stored in a format that facilitates updating, maintenance, and development. For example, the master geographic database **101** or data in the master geographic database **101** can be in an Oracle spatial format or other spatial format, such as for development or production purposes. The Oracle spatial format or development/production database can be compiled into a delivery format, such as a geographic data files (GDF) format. The data in the production and/or delivery formats can be compiled or further compiled to form geographic database products or databases, which can be used in end user navigation devices or systems.

(101) For example, geographic data is compiled (such as into a platform specification format (PSF) format) to organize and/or configure the data for performing navigation-related functions and/or services, such as autonomous vehicle operation, route calculation, route guidance, map display, speed calculation, distance and travel time functions, and other functions, by a navigation device, such as by a vehicle or mobile device. The navigation-related functions can correspond to vehicle navigation, pedestrian navigation, or other types of navigation. The compilation to produce the end user databases can be performed by a party or entity separate from the map developer. For example, a customer of the map developer, such as a navigation device developer or other end user device developer, can perform compilation on a received geographic database in a delivery format to produce one or more compiled navigation databases.

(102) As mentioned above, the geographic database **101** can be a master geographic database, but in alternate embodiments, the geographic database **101** can represent a compiled navigation database that can be used in or with end user devices (e.g., map clients **105**) to provide mapping and/or navigation-related functions. For example, the geographic database **101** can be used with the end user device to provide an end user with navigation features. In such a case, the geographic database **101** can be downloaded or stored on the end user device (e.g., map client **105**). The end user device can access the geographic database **101** through a wireless or wired connection (such as via a server and/or the communication network **111**), for example.

(103) In one embodiment, the end user device can be an in-vehicle navigation system, an autonomous vehicle control system, a personal navigation device (PND), a portable navigation device, a cellular telephone, a mobile phone, a personal digital assistant (PDA), a watch, a camera, a computer, and/or other device that can perform navigation-related functions, such as digital

routing and map display. In one embodiment, the navigation device can be a cellular telephone. An end user can use the device navigation functions such as guidance and map display, for example, and for determination of route information to at least one identified point of interest, according to exemplary embodiments.

(104) The processes described herein for providing mock map data for map design validation and documentation may be advantageously implemented via software, hardware (e.g., general processor, Digital Signal Processing (DSP) chip, an Application Specific Integrated Circuit (ASIC), Field Programmable Gate Arrays (FPGAs), etc.), firmware or a combination thereof. Such exemplary hardware for performing the described functions is detailed below.

(105) FIG. **8** illustrates a computer system **800** upon which an embodiment of the invention may be implemented. Computer system **800** is programmed (e.g., via computer program code or instructions) to provide mock map data as described herein and includes a communication mechanism such as a bus **810** for passing information between other internal and external components of the computer system **800**. Information (also called data) is represented as a physical expression of a measurable phenomenon, typically electric voltages, but including, in other embodiments, such phenomena as magnetic, electromagnetic, pressure, chemical, biological, molecular, atomic, sub-atomic and quantum interactions. For example, north and south magnetic fields, or a zero and non-zero electric voltage, represent two states (**0**, **1**) of a binary digit (bit). Other phenomena can represent digits of a higher base. A superposition of multiple simultaneous quantum states before measurement represents a quantum bit (qubit). A sequence of one or more digits constitutes digital data that is used to represent a number or code for a character. In some embodiments, information called analog data is represented by a near continuum of measurable values within a particular range.

(106) A bus **810** includes one or more parallel conductors of information so that information is transferred quickly among devices coupled to the bus **810**. One or more processors **802** for processing information are coupled with the bus **810**.

(107) A processor **802** performs a set of operations on information as specified by computer program code related to providing mock map data. The computer program code is a set of instructions or statements providing instructions for the operation of the processor and/or the computer system to perform specified functions. The code, for example, may be written in a computer programming language that is compiled into a native instruction set of the processor. The code may also be written directly using the native instruction set (e.g., machine language). The set of operations include bringing information in from the bus **810** and placing information on the bus **810**. The set of operations also typically include comparing two or more units of information, shifting positions of units of information, and combining two or more units of information, such as by addition or multiplication or logical operations like OR, exclusive OR (XOR), and AND. Each operation of the set of operations that can be performed by the processor is represented to the processor by information called instructions, such as an operation code of one or more digits. A sequence of operations to be executed by the processor **802**, such as a sequence of operation codes, constitute processor instructions, also called computer system instructions or, simply, computer instructions. Processors may be implemented as mechanical, electrical, magnetic, optical, chemical or quantum components, among others, alone or in combination.

(108) Computer system **800** also includes a memory **804** coupled to bus **810**. The memory **804**, such as a random access memory (RAM) or other dynamic storage device, stores information including processor instructions for providing mock map data. Dynamic memory allows information stored therein to be changed by the computer system **800**. RAM allows a unit of information stored at a location called a memory address to be stored and retrieved independently of information at neighboring addresses. The memory **804** is also used by the processor **802** to store temporary values during execution of processor instructions. The computer system **800** also includes a read only memory (ROM) **806** or other static storage device coupled to the bus **810** for

storing static information, including instructions, that is not changed by the computer system **800**. Some memory is composed of volatile storage that loses the information stored thereon when power is lost. Also coupled to bus **810** is a non-volatile (persistent) storage device **808**, such as a magnetic disk, optical disk or flash card, for storing information, including instructions, that persists even when the computer system **800** is turned off or otherwise loses power.

(109) Information, including instructions for providing mock map data, is provided to the bus **810** for use by the processor from an external input device **812**, such as a keyboard containing alphanumeric keys operated by a human user, or a sensor. A sensor detects conditions in its vicinity and transforms those detections into physical expression compatible with the measurable phenomenon used to represent information in computer system **800**. Other external devices coupled to bus **810**, used primarily for interacting with humans, include a display device **814**, such as a cathode ray tube (CRT) or a liquid crystal display (LCD), or plasma screen or printer for presenting text or images, and a pointing device **816**, such as a mouse or a trackball or cursor direction keys, or motion sensor, for controlling a position of a small cursor image presented on the display **814** and issuing commands associated with graphical elements presented on the display **814**. In some embodiments, for example, in embodiments in which the computer system **800** performs all functions automatically without human input, one or more of external input device **812**, display device **814** and pointing device **816** is omitted.

(110) In the illustrated embodiment, special purpose hardware, such as an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC) **820**, is coupled to bus **810**. The special purpose hardware is configured to perform operations not performed by processor **802** quickly enough for special purposes. Examples of application specific ICs include graphics accelerator cards for generating images for display **814**, cryptographic boards for encrypting and decrypting messages sent over a network, speech recognition, and interfaces to special external devices, such as robotic arms and medical scanning equipment that repeatedly perform some complex sequence of operations that are more efficiently implemented in hardware.

(111) Computer system **800** also includes one or more instances of a communications interface **870** coupled to bus **810**. Communication interface **870** provides a one-way or two-way communication coupling to a variety of external devices that operate with their own processors, such as printers, scanners and external disks. In general the coupling is with a network link **878** that is connected to a local network **880** to which a variety of external devices with their own processors are connected. For example, communication interface **870** may be a parallel port or a serial port or a universal serial bus (USB) port on a personal computer. In some embodiments, communications interface **870** is an integrated services digital network (ISDN) card or a digital subscriber line (DSL) card or a telephone modem that provides an information communication connection to a corresponding type of telephone line. In some embodiments, a communication interface **870** is a cable modem that converts signals on bus **810** into signals for a communication connection over a coaxial cable or into optical signals for a communication connection over a fiber optic cable. As another example, communications interface **870** may be a local area network (LAN) card to provide a data communication connection to a compatible LAN, such as Ethernet. Wireless links may also be implemented. For wireless links, the communications interface **870** sends or receives or both sends and receives electrical, acoustic or electromagnetic signals, including infrared and optical signals, that carry information streams, such as digital data. For example, in wireless handheld devices, such as mobile telephones like cell phones, the communications interface **870** includes a radio band electromagnetic transmitter and receiver called a radio transceiver. In certain embodiments, the communications interface **870** enables connection to the communication network **111** for providing mock map data to the map client **105**.

(112) The term computer-readable medium is used herein to refer to any medium that participates in providing information to processor **802**, including instructions for execution. Such a medium may take many forms, including, but not limited to, non-volatile media, volatile media and

transmission media. Non-volatile media include, for example, optical or magnetic disks, such as storage device **808**. Volatile media include, for example, dynamic memory **804**. Transmission media include, for example, coaxial cables, copper wire, fiber optic cables, and carrier waves that travel through space without wires or cables, such as acoustic waves and electromagnetic waves, including radio, optical and infrared waves. Signals include man-made transient variations in amplitude, frequency, phase, polarization or other physical properties transmitted through the transmission media. Common forms of computer-readable media include, for example, a floppy disk, a flexible disk, hard disk, magnetic tape, any other magnetic medium, a CD-ROM, CDRW, DVD, any other optical medium, punch cards, paper tape, optical mark sheets, any other physical medium with patterns of holes or other optically recognizable indicia, a RAM, a PROM, an EPROM, a FLASH-EPROM, any other memory chip or cartridge, a carrier wave, or any other medium from which a computer can read.

(113) Network link **878** typically provides information communication using transmission media through one or more networks to other devices that use or process the information. For example, network link **878** may provide a connection through local network **880** to a host computer **882** or to equipment **884** operated by an Internet Service Provider (ISP). ISP equipment **884** in turn provides data communication services through the public, world-wide packet-switching communication network of networks now commonly referred to as the Internet **890**.

(114) A computer called a server host **892** connected to the Internet hosts a process that provides a service in response to information received over the Internet. For example, server host **892** hosts a process that provides information representing video data for presentation at display **814**. It is contemplated that the components of system can be deployed in various configurations within other computer systems, e.g., host **882** and server **892**.

(115) FIG. **9** illustrates a chip set **900** upon which an embodiment of the invention may be implemented. Chip set **900** is programmed to provide mock map data as described herein and includes, for instance, the processor and memory components described with respect to FIG. **8** incorporated in one or more physical packages (e.g., chips). By way of example, a physical package includes an arrangement of one or more materials, components, and/or wires on a structural assembly (e.g., a baseboard) to provide one or more characteristics such as physical strength, conservation of size, and/or limitation of electrical interaction. It is contemplated that in certain embodiments the chip set can be implemented in a single chip.

(116) In one embodiment, the chip set **900** includes a communication mechanism such as a bus **901** for passing information among the components of the chip set **900**. A processor **903** has connectivity to the bus **901** to execute instructions and process information stored in, for example, a memory **905**. The processor **903** may include one or more processing cores with each core configured to perform independently. A multi-core processor enables multiprocessing within a single physical package. Examples of a multi-core processor include two, four, eight, or greater numbers of processing cores. Alternatively or in addition, the processor **903** may include one or more microprocessors configured in tandem via the bus **901** to enable independent execution of instructions, pipelining, and multithreading. The processor **903** may also be accompanied with one or more specialized components to perform certain processing functions and tasks such as one or more digital signal processors (DSP) **907**, or one or more application-specific integrated circuits (ASIC) **909**. A DSP **907** typically is configured to process real-world signals (e.g., sound) in real time independently of the processor **903**. Similarly, an ASIC **909** can be configured to performed specialized functions not easily performed by a general purposed processor. Other specialized components to aid in performing the inventive functions described herein include one or more field programmable gate arrays (FPGA) (not shown), one or more controllers (not shown), or one or more other special-purpose computer chips.

(117) The processor **903** and accompanying components have connectivity to the memory **905** via the bus **901**. The memory **905** includes both dynamic memory (e.g., RAM, magnetic disk, writable

optical disk, etc.) and static memory (e.g., ROM, CD-ROM, etc.) for storing executable instructions that when executed perform the inventive steps described herein to provide mock map data. The memory **905** also stores the data associated with or generated by the execution of the inventive steps.

(118) FIG. **10** is a diagram of exemplary components of a mobile terminal (e.g., handset) capable of operating in the system of FIG. **1**, according to one embodiment. Generally, a radio receiver is often defined in terms of front-end and back-end characteristics. The front-end of the receiver encompasses all of the Radio Frequency (RF) circuitry whereas the back-end encompasses all of the base-band processing circuitry. Pertinent internal components of the telephone include a Main Control Unit (MCU) **1003**, a Digital Signal Processor (DSP) **1005**, and a receiver/transmitter unit including a microphone gain control unit and a speaker gain control unit. A main display unit **1007** provides a display to the user in support of various applications and mobile station functions that offer automatic contact matching. An audio function circuitry **1009** includes a microphone **1011** and microphone amplifier that amplifies the speech signal output from the microphone **1011**. The amplified speech signal output from the microphone **1011** is fed to a coder/decoder (CODEC) **1013**.

(119) A radio section **1015** amplifies power and converts frequency in order to communicate with a base station, which is included in a mobile communication system, via antenna **1017**. The power amplifier (PA) **1019** and the transmitter/modulation circuitry are operationally responsive to the MCU **1003**, with an output from the PA **1019** coupled to the duplexer **1021** or circulator or antenna switch, as known in the art. The PA **1019** also couples to a battery interface and power control unit **1020**.

(120) In use, a user of mobile station **1001** speaks into the microphone **1011** and his or her voice along with any detected background noise is converted into an analog voltage. The analog voltage is then converted into a digital signal through the Analog to Digital Converter (ADC) **1023**. The control unit **1003** routes the digital signal into the DSP **1005** for processing therein, such as speech encoding, channel encoding, encrypting, and interleaving. In one embodiment, the processed voice signals are encoded, by units not separately shown, using a cellular transmission protocol such as global evolution (EDGE), general packet radio service (GPRS), global system for mobile communications (GSM), Internet protocol multimedia subsystem (IMS), universal mobile telecommunications system (UMTS), etc., as well as any other suitable wireless medium, e.g., microwave access (WiMAX), Long Term Evolution (LTE) networks, 5G New Radio networks, code division multiple access (CDMA), wireless fidelity (WiFi), satellite, and the like.

(121) The encoded signals are then routed to an equalizer **1025** for compensation of any frequency-dependent impairments that occur during transmission through the air such as phase and amplitude distortion. After equalizing the bit stream, the modulator **1027** combines the signal with a RF signal generated in the RF interface **1029**. The modulator **1027** generates a sine wave by way of frequency or phase modulation. In order to prepare the signal for transmission, an up-converter **1031** combines the sine wave output from the modulator **1027** with another sine wave generated by a synthesizer **1033** to achieve the desired frequency of transmission. The signal is then sent through a PA **1019** to increase the signal to an appropriate power level. In practical systems, the PA **1019** acts as a variable gain amplifier whose gain is controlled by the DSP **1005** from information received from a network base station. The signal is then filtered within the duplexer **1021** and optionally sent to an antenna coupler **1035** to match impedances to provide maximum power transfer. Finally, the signal is transmitted via antenna **1017** to a local base station. An automatic gain control (AGC) can be supplied to control the gain of the final stages of the receiver. The signals may be forwarded from there to a remote telephone which may be another cellular telephone, other mobile phone or a land-line connected to a Public Switched Telephone Network (PSTN), or other telephony networks.

(122) Voice signals transmitted to the mobile station **1001** are received via antenna **1017** and

immediately amplified by a low noise amplifier (LNA) **1037**. A down-converter **1039** lowers the carrier frequency while the demodulator **1041** strips away the RF leaving only a digital bit stream. The signal then goes through the equalizer **1025** and is processed by the DSP **1005**. A Digital to Analog Converter (DAC) **1043** converts the signal and the resulting output is transmitted to the user through the speaker **1045**, all under control of a Main Control Unit (MCU) **1003**—which can be implemented as a Central Processing Unit (CPU) (not shown).

(123) The MCU **1003** receives various signals including input signals from the keyboard **1047**. The keyboard **1047** and/or the MCU **1003** in combination with other user input components (e.g., the microphone **1011**) comprise a user interface circuitry for managing user input. The MCU **1003** runs a user interface software to facilitate user control of at least some functions of the mobile station **1001** to provide mock map data. The MCU **1003** also delivers a display command and a switch command to the display **1007** and to the speech output switching controller, respectively. Further, the MCU **1003** exchanges information with the DSP **1005** and can access an optionally incorporated SIM card **1049** and a memory **1051**. In addition, the MCU **1003** executes various control functions required of the station. The DSP **1005** may, depending upon the implementation, perform any of a variety of conventional digital processing functions on the voice signals. Additionally, DSP **1005** determines the background noise level of the local environment from the signals detected by microphone **1011** and sets the gain of microphone **1011** to a level selected to compensate for the natural tendency of the user of the mobile station **1001**.

(124) The CODEC **1013** includes the ADC **1023** and DAC **1043**. The memory **1051** stores various data including call incoming tone data and is capable of storing other data including music data received via, e.g., the global Internet. The software module could reside in RAM memory, flash memory, registers, or any other form of writable computer-readable storage medium known in the art including non-transitory computer-readable storage medium. For example, the memory device **1051** may be, but not limited to, a single memory, CD, DVD, ROM, RAM, EEPROM, optical storage, or any other non-volatile or non-transitory storage medium capable of storing digital data.

(125) An optionally incorporated SIM card **1049** carries, for instance, important information, such as the cellular phone number, the carrier supplying service, subscription details, and security information. The SIM card **1049** serves primarily to identify the mobile station **1001** on a radio network. The card **1049** also contains a memory for storing a personal telephone number registry, text messages, and user specific mobile station settings.

(126) While the invention has been described in connection with a number of embodiments and implementations, the invention is not so limited but covers various obvious modifications and equivalent arrangements, which fall within the purview of the appended claims. Although features of the invention are expressed in certain combinations among the claims, it is contemplated that these features can be arranged in any combination and order.

Claims

1. A computer-implemented method comprising: receiving, by a mock map data server, an input specifying one or more map feature attributes to generate mock map data, wherein the mock map data are procedurally generated, and wherein procedurally generated comprises using a processor to synthetically generate the mock map data based on the one or more map feature attributes using one or more preconfigured rules, and wherein the input is received via a user interface presented on an input device; calculating, by the mock map data server, one or more combinations of one or more feature attribute values of the one or more map feature attributes, wherein the one or more feature attributes are one or more types of cartographic features, and wherein the one or more map feature attribute values indicate a size or a class of the one or more types of cartographic features; creating, by the mock map data server, one or more geometric features respectively for the one or more combinations; using, by the mock map data server, the one or more preconfigured rules to

automatically arrange the one or more geometric features into a pattern that equally spaces the one or more geometric features within a designated geographic area; procedurally generating, by the mock map data server, the mock map data based on the pattern; storing, by the mock map data server, the mock map data in a mock map database accessible via the mock map data server, wherein the mock map data is stored in a map data format that is compatible with a real-world map data of a mapping platform that is accessible by a map client; and modifying, by the mock map data server, a server URL configured in the map client to redirect the map client from the mapping platform to the mock map data server, wherein the map client receives the mock map data from the mock map data server using the modified server URL and renders the mock map data in a map image on a display device based on a map style taxonomy.

2. The method of claim 1, wherein the mock map data is generated at one or more map zoom levels.

3. The method of claim 1, wherein the map style taxonomy assigns one or more visual attributes respectively to the one or more map feature attributes, the one or more map feature attribute values, the one or more combinations, or a combination thereof, and wherein the one or more visual attributes are rendered in the map image to represent the one or more map feature attributes, the one or more map feature attribute values, the one or more combinations, or a combination thereof.

4. The method of claim 1, further comprising: providing the rendered map image as an output that visually documents the map style taxonomy.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein the pattern arranges the one or more geometric features into at least one of a point grid, a horizontal line, a vertical line, a horizontal strip, a vertical strip, a rectangle grid, and a concentric circular grid.

6. The method of claim 1, wherein the pattern arranges the one or more geometric features into an intersecting arrangement of the one or more map feature attributes, the one or more attribute values, or a combination.

7. The method of claim 1, wherein the mock map data is generated in a vector tile format.

8. The method of claim 1, wherein the pattern is determined based on a specified feature density, a specified feature gap distance, or a combination thereof between the one or more geometric features.

9. The method of claim 1, wherein the one or more map feature attributes, the one or more map feature attribute values, or a combination thereof are not currently represented in the real-world map data.

10. An apparatus comprising: at least one processor; and at least one memory including computer program code for one or more programs, the at least one memory and the computer program code configured to, with the at least one processor, cause the apparatus to perform at least the following, receive, by a mock map data server, an input specifying one or more map feature attributes to generate mock map data, wherein the mock map data are procedurally generated, wherein procedurally generated comprises using the at least one processor to synthetically generate the mock map data based on the one or more map feature attributes using one or more preconfigured rules, and wherein the input is received via a user interface presented on an input device; calculate, by the mock map data server, one or more combinations of one or more feature attribute values of the one or more map feature attributes, wherein the one or more feature attributes are one or more types of cartographic features, and wherein the one or more map feature attribute values indicate a size or a class of the one or more types of cartographic features; create, by the mock map data server, one or more geometric features respectively for the one or more combinations; use, by the mock map data server, the one or more preconfigured rules to automatically arrange the one or more geometric features into a pattern that equally spaces the one or more geometric features within a designated geographic area; procedurally generate, by the mock map data server, the mock map data based on the pattern; store, by the mock map data server, the mock map data in a mock map database accessible via a mock map data server, wherein the mock map data is stored in a map

data format that is compatible with a real-world map data of a mapping platform that is accessible by a map client; and modify, by the mock map data server, a server URL configured in the map client to redirect the map client from the mapping platform to the mock map data server, wherein the map client receives the mock map data from the mock map data server using the modified server URL and renders the mock map data in a map image on a display device based on a map style taxonomy.

11. The apparatus of claim 10, wherein the mock map data is generated at one or more map zoom levels.

12. The apparatus of claim 10, wherein the map style taxonomy assigns one or more visual attributes respectively to the one or more map feature attributes, the one or more map feature attribute values, the one or more combinations, or a combination thereof, and wherein the one or more visual attributes are rendered in the map image to represent the one or more map feature attributes, the one or more map feature attribute values, the one or more combinations, or a combination thereof.

13. The apparatus of claim 10, wherein the apparatus further caused to: provide the rendered map image as an output that visually documents the map style taxonomy.

14. A non-transitory computer readable storage medium carrying one or more sequences of one or more instructions which, when the one or more instructions are executed by one or more processors, cause an apparatus to perform: receiving, by a mock map data server, an input specifying one or more map feature attributes to generate mock map data, wherein the mock map data are procedurally generated, wherein procedurally generated comprises using the one or more processors to synthetically generate the mock map data based on the one or more map feature attributes using one or more preconfigured rules, and wherein the input is received via a user interface presented on an input device; calculating, by the mock map data server, one or more combinations of one or more feature attribute values of the one or more map feature attributes, wherein the one or more feature attributes are one or more types of cartographic features, and wherein the one or more map feature attribute values indicate a size or a class of the one or more types of cartographic features; creating, by the mock map data server, one or more geometric features respectively for the one or more combinations; using, by the mock map data server, the one or more preconfigured rules to automatically arrange the one or more geometric features into a pattern that equally spaces the one or more geometric features within a designated geographic area; procedurally generating, by the mock map data server, the mock map data based on the pattern; storing, by the mock map data server, the mock map data in a mock map database accessible via the mock map data server, wherein the mock map data is stored in a map data format that is compatible with a real-world map data of a mapping platform that is accessible by a map client; and modifying, by the mock map data server, a server URL configured in the map client to redirect the map client from the mapping platform to the mock map data server, wherein the map client receives the mock map data from the mock map data server using the modified server URL and renders the mock map data in a map image on a display device based on a map style taxonomy.

15. The non-transitory computer readable storage medium of claim 14, wherein the mock map data is generated at one or more map zoom levels.

16. The non-transitory computer readable storage medium of claim 14, wherein the map style taxonomy assigns one or more visual attributes respectively to the one or more map feature attributes, the one or more map feature attribute values, the one or more combinations, or a combination thereof, and wherein the one or more visual attributes are rendered in the map image to represent the one or more map feature attributes, the one or more map feature attribute values, the one or more combinations, or a combination thereof.

17. The non-transitory computer readable storage medium of claim 14, wherein the apparatus is caused to further perform: providing the rendered map image as an output that visually documents the map style taxonomy.

18. The non-transitory computer readable storage medium of claim 14, wherein the pattern arranges the one or more geometric features into at least one of a point grid, a horizontal line, a vertical line, a horizontal strip, a vertical strip, and a rectangle grid.

19. The method of claim 1, wherein the pattern arranges the one or more geometric features into an intersecting arrangement of the one or more map features, the one or more attribute values, or a combination thereof; and wherein the intersecting arrangement arranges the one or more map features along vertical lines, horizontal lines, and/or concentric circular lines.
